

Deep Work

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8-slide visual summary

Core concepts • mental models • easy-to-remember diagrams •
practical takeaways

The Core Advantage

Deep work is distraction-free concentration on demanding work.



- It creates high-value output.
- It builds skills quickly.
- It is increasingly rare.

Deep vs Shallow

Protect your best mental energy for valuable work.

DEEP WORK

High-value Concentrated Creates skill

SHALLOW WORK

Routine Interruptible Necessary, but limited

- Deep: coding, design, strategy, learning.
- Shallow: routine email and admin.
- Both exist; they deserve different budgets.

The Deep Work Ritual

Make concentration a repeatable ritual.



- Choose where and when.
- Define the task and finish line.
- Remove distractions.
- Set a fixed duration.

Attention Residue

Task switching leaves attention behind.



- Notifications create re-entry costs.
- Batch communication.
- Avoid constant context switching.

Four Rules

Work deeply • Embrace boredom • Control tools • Drain shallow work



Schedule depth



Embrace boredom



Control tools



Reduce shallow

- Schedule deep blocks.
- Train your attention.
- Use tools only when they support goals.
- Reduce low-value commitments.

A Practical Day

Turn deep work into a daily operating system.

DEEP

MEETINGS

SHALLOW

DEEP

SHUTDOWN

- Morning: one or two deep blocks.
- Meetings and shallow work later.
- Optional second deep block.
- End with a shutdown ritual.

Memory Map

Focus → Ritual → Depth → High-value Output



- Treat attention as scarce.
- Do fewer things with greater intensity.
- Finish with a deliberate shutdown.